CHAPTER TWENTY-TWO

DOLAKHA NEWAR

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1 INTRODUCTION

Dolakha Newar is a Tibeto-Burman language spoken in the village of Dolakha, approximately 145 kilometres to the east of Kathmandu, Nepal.[1] The language has been referred to as Dolakhali, Dolakha (Newar), and Dolakhae. The latter form contains the genitive morpheme = *e*, thus means 'of Dolakha', and is the form used by the speakers to refer to themselves and their language. I will use the terms Dolakhae and Dolakha Newar interchangeably.

Dolakhae is clearly in the Newar family and is closely related to the dialects of Newar spoken in the Kathmandu Valley and other locations throughout Nepal. I prefer to refer to Dolakhae as a 'language' as opposed to a 'dialect' of Newar, as it is mutually unintelligible with the Newar spoken in the Kathmandu Valley. There are a number of features that contribute to this, most notably the retention of final consonants, the loss of breathy voice, the presence of a full subject-agreement paradigm on the verb, and different morphology for nominalization, a ubiquitous construction in both languages. Historical records indicate that the split of Dolakhae from the other dialects occurred a minimum of 700 years ago, perhaps much earlier.

The number of speakers of this language is unknown, as many Dolakha Newars have migrated to other parts of Nepal and beyond to seek employment. The number is likely to be between 5,000 and 10,000, probably towards the lower end of this range. The current trend is for young adults from the village to move out to Kathmandu or other cities for business and educational opportunities, and to marry within the wider Newar community. Consequently, many of the current children of Dolakha Newars are not learning to speak the language. On the other hand, the people of Dolakha in the outlying areas have a strong civic commitment to the village and sense of community. Several groups have grown up dedicated to maintaining the language and culture of the Dolakhae people.

It is not known if there are any true dialectal divisions within the Dolakhae language. The village of Dolakha is relatively small and homogeneous, thus unlikely to give rise to significant dialectal development. However, while the relevance of dialect is questionable, the notion of idiolect is clearly important. My two primary consultants were two young female cousins who grew up in the same household until they were about eight years old. They always conversed freely with each other and never noticed any differences in their speech. However, as I worked with the two of them I found linguistic differences in a number of areas, including different vowel harmony patterns, different inflections of the copula, and different patterns of use of the nominalizers. Later I worked with another, younger, cousin, and found yet another pattern of vowel harmony. These differences seem to be the result of different analyses of occurrent patterns during language acquisition, probably reflecting variation already present in the speech of the preceding generations.

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The goal of the current chapter is to provide information on the most central aspects of the grammar of Dolakhae. The final section (6) contains a brief narrative which allows the reader to obtain a truer sense of the language. When possible, the description of the language will be indexed with references to the text, with line numbers enclosed in angled brackets, e.g. <10>. Space limitations require brevity; for further work on the language, see Genetti (2007) and works cited therein (pp. 22–3), especially Shrestha (1996).

A list of abbreviations specific to this chapter is given in an appendix.

2 PHONOLOGY

The consonant phonemes of Dolakhae are given in (1):

(1)	p, ph, b	t, th, d	ṭ, ṭh, ḍ	c, ch, j	k, kh, g
	m	n			ŋ
		s			h
		l	r		
	w			y	

Of particular interest are the presence of a retroflex series of consonants (not attested in other Newar dialects), and the absence of breathy voice. The former is attested by the minimal pairs *tār*- 'hear' 'hear' and *ṭār*- 'fix', *thon*- 'hide' and *ṭhon*- 'wake', and *don*- 'finish', *ḍon*- 'stand'. The dental/retroflex distinction was probably a feature of Proto-Newar, and has been lost in other dialects. Note that the symbols /c, ch, j/ represent alveo-palatal affricates.

There are a few words in Dolakhae with breathy-voiced stops; however, there is no evidence of breathy-voiced nasals or approximants, as found in Kathmandu Newar. Most of the vocabulary items with breathy voice are clearly borrowings from Nepali or Sanskrit. There are a few Newar words which speakers pronounce with *dh* or *jh* in careful pronunciation, such as *dhũ* 'tiger' and *jhi* 'ten'; however, the breathy voice is variable across speakers and it is not heard in connected speech. It is notable that some Dolakhae speakers pronounce some Nepali breathy consonants with plain phonation, e.g. *ghar* 'house' is pronounced by some as *gar*.

One other note on the consonant inventory is that two of these 'phonemes' are actually in complementary distribution. The retroflex stop /ɖ/ occurs in word-initial position, while the tap /r/ occurs between vowels and at the end of a syllable. On purely distributional grounds, these two are allophones of one phoneme and should be represented as such. However, the two sounds are different phonetically, and speakers insist that they are distinct. This is probably attributable to these sounds being phonemically distinct in Nepali (an Indo-Aryan language, the national language of Nepal, which all Dolakhae speakers are bilingual in), and to their being represented by different characters in the Devanagari alphabet. So although distributional criteria argue for a single phoneme, I prefer to analyse them as two, which I take to be a more accurate reflection of speaker knowledge.

The vowel phonemes of Dolakhae are given in (2):

(2)	i, ĩ	u, ũ
	e, ẽ	o, õ
	ā, ã̆	a, ã

The vowel /ā/ is low and central, while /a/ ranges from the low, back [ɑ] to [ʌ] and [ə]. The vowel /o/ has a wide range of phonetic variants, some of them predictable, including

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[wa], [wo], [o] and [ʔo]. The phoneme /e/ also has a range of predictable variants: [e], [ɛ], [ʌ], [je].

There are some interesting patterns of vowels in combination. In a sequence of two identical high vowels across a morpheme boundary, one vowel elides, e.g. *bi-i* → [bi] 'give-INF'. By contrast, if two repetitions of /e/ come together across a morpheme boundary, both vowels are pronounced, and each has a distinct pulse, indicating two syllables: *ye-e* [ye.e] 'come-NR2'. However if the /e/ of the suffix is followed by another element, then the /e/ changes to [ɛ]: *ye-eu* [ye.ɛu] 'come-3SFUT'. When a suffix beginning with /e/ follows another vowel, disyllabic sequences result: *tā-eu* [tā.ɛu] 'hear-3SFUT'. If the preceding vowel is high, then a glide is inserted: *si-eu* [si.yɛu] 'die-3SFUT'.

The three prefixes of the language all exhibit vowel harmony. The harmony patterns do not seem to be regularized among the community. The most elaborate pattern found among the three speakers I have worked with in depth is illustrated here with the negative prefix *ma-*:

(3)

ma-ta-u	NEG-put-3SPAST
ma-ye-ŋ	NEG-bring-3SPAST
ma-tul	NEG-fall.3SPAST
ma-sit	NEG-die.3SPAST
mā-tā-u	NEG-hear-3SPAST
mo-cõ	NEG-stay.3SPAST
mo-tul	NEG-fall.3SPAST
mwā-mwāl	NEG-search.3SPAST

Consonant clusters with the glide /y/ block the harmony process, thus *ma-ŋyāt* [NEG-buy.3SPAST] 'don't buy!'.

Dolakhae does not have tone. Words pronounced in isolation have stress on the initial syllable of a root; however, this pattern is overridden by intonational contours in connected speech (Genetti 2007: 64, 68).

3 MORPHOLOGY

3.1 Nouns and pronouns

Dolakhae has separate pronouns for first (*ji*), second (*chi*) and third (*ām*) person. An inclusive/exclusive distinction is found with first person plural; compare *isi* 'we' (exclusive) with *thiji/chiji* 'we' (inclusive). The latter is transparently formed from a combination of the first- and second person pronouns. There is also a second person honorific pronoun *thamu.* Second- and third person plurals are formed with the plural morpheme *-pen*; they are *chipen* and *āpen* respectively. Case inflection of pronouns involves idiosyncratic morphophonemics, although the case elements are always transparent. Pronouns in the accompanying text are found in <55, 69, 70, 75, 76>.

Nouns and pronouns inflect for number and case. Number marking is limited to a single morpheme: *-pen*. This morpheme can be used to indicate plurality and it can also be used with a collective sense <51>. There is very little nominal derivational morphology in Dolakhae. A single diminutive suffix *-cā* is used to indicate the young of animals, e.g. *sā* 'cow', *sā-cā* 'calf'. (The use of this suffix is more widespread in the Kathmandu dialect, where it is a general diminutive.) There is no nominal marking for gender.

The Dolakhae casemarkers are morphological clitics (except for the associative, which is a postposition). They are listed in (4):

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(4)			
	Ergative	= na, = n	<28, 29, 55, 61, 69>
	Instrumental	= na, = n	<6, 26, 27>
	Dative	= ta	<33, 54, 69>
	Genitive	= e	<43, 64, 75>
	Locative	= ku	<13, 17, 20, 31, 32, 70>
	Associative	nāpa	
	Allative	= ke	
	Ablative	= lān	<14, 30>

The use of the ergative is obligatory on all subjects of transitive verbs. There is no split ergativity, by aspect, person or NP type, and neither does ergative casemarking depend on semantic or discourse-pragmatic patterns. Instead, all Dolakhae verbs are classified according to whether they are transitive (may take an object) or intransitive (may not), and subjects of all transitive verbs are ergative. Instrumental case is syncretic with the ergative.

The dative marks all recipients of ditransitive verbs. It is also found on patient arguments of transitive verbs which are human and whose referent is given or accessible. Patients of transitive verbs and recipients of ditransitive verbs are grammatical objects. The dative is also found marking subjects but only with dative-subject predicates borrowed from Nepali (e.g. <33–34> Nepali *samjhanu* 'remember'), or calques on Nepali dative-subject predicates using Dolakhae vocabulary. In addition, the dative is used on objects of exchange and on benefactive objects. In the latter case, the predicate must contain the auxiliary verb *bir-* 'give'.

The oblique cases require little comment. The locative and allative differ primarily in that the allative references an animate goal. Inanimate goals are marked with the locative.

3.2 Numerals and classifiers

There are both decimal- and vigesimal-based systems of numerals. The systems are identical up until thirty-nine. The numerals for one to twenty are given in (5). The suffix *-gur* is the general numeral classifier that is always used when counting.

(5)				
	thi-gur	'one'	*j(h)im-thi-gur*	'11'
	nis-gur	'two'	*j(h)im-nis-gur*	'12'
	sõ-gur	'three'	*j(h)im-sõ-gur*	'13'
	pe-gur/ pẽ-gur	'four'	*j(h)im-pe-gur*	'14'
	ŋā-gur	'five'	*j(h)im-ŋā-gur*	'15'
	khu-gur	'six'	*j(h)im-khu-gur*	'16'
	nas-gur	'seven'	*j(h)im-nas-gur*	'17'
	cyā-gur	'eight'	*j(h)im-cyā-gur*	'18'
	gu-gur	'nine'	*j(h)im-gu-gur*	'19'
	j(h)i-gur	'ten'	*ni(i)-gur*	'20'

'Thirty' is *swi.* The decimal and vigesimal systems diverge in the multiples of ten from '40' to '90':

(6)	Decimal	Vigesimal	
	pi-gur	*ne-ni-nis-ṭhãĩ*	'40'
	ŋāi-gur	*ne-ni-nis-ṭhãĩ-o-j(h)i-gur*	'50'
	khwi-gur	*ne-ni-sõ-ṭhãĩ*	'60'

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nai-gur	*ne-ni-sõ-ṭhãĩ-o-j(h)i-gur*	'70'
cyai-gur	*ne-ni-pi-ṭhãĩ*	'80'
gwi-gur	*ne-ni-pi-ṭhãĩ-o-j(h)i-gur*	'90'

The decimal system is constructed by adding a simple *-i* suffix to the numeral. This can then be followed by another numeral indicating the one's place, e.g. *ŋa-i-pe* '54'. The vigesimal system takes as its base the sequence *ne-ni*, which speakers translate as 'twenty-twenty'. These collocations end in the noun *ṭhãĩ* 'place', which replaces the classifier, so '40' and '60' translate as 'twenty-twenty-two-places' and 'twenty-twenty-three-places' respectively. To designate the odd multiples of ten, *o j(h)i* 'and ten' is added; one can also add 11 to 19, e.g. *ne-ni-pi-ṭhãĩ-o-j(h)im-ŋā-gur* '95'. As these collocation end in numerals, the classifier is again required.

'Hundred' is indicated by the mensural classifier *sar* – e.g. *nas-sar* '700' – and 'thousand' is indicated by the mensural classifier *dol* (*nis-dol* '2,000').

Dolakhae numerals never occur as bare stems, but are always followed by a bound classifier. The numeral–classifier combination generally precedes the modified noun. There are 30 classifiers that I know of. Classifiers only occur with numerals; they are not found with demonstratives or other nominal modifiers. Some classifiers are transparently derived from nouns, but none are identical to nouns which they classify (i.e. there are no 'echo classifiers' in the language). The majority of members of a class are usually amenable to semantic classification. A full description of the classifiers can be found in Genetti (2007: 220–7). Of particular interest and centrality are *-mā* for animates, *-gar* for roundish things, *-kã̄* for implements, *-pā* for relatively rigid long things, *-pu* for relatively flexible long things, *-darpā* for bowls of yogurt, *-kto/koto* for pieces or chunks of food, and *-gur* as a general classifier. Auto-classifiers include *–nu* for days, *-chi* for nights, *-lā* for months, *–da* for years, and *–oti* for words. Classifiers in the text are found in <1, 2, 16>.

3.3 Adjectives and deverbal modifiers

Most modifiers of nouns that denote property concepts (those commonly coded by a lexical class of adjectives in the world's languages) are derived from verbs in Dolakhae. For example *bã̄la-ku* 'beautiful' is a nominalized form of the verb *bã̄lat-* 'become beautiful' <75>. Similar examples are *hāka-u* 'black' from *hākar-* 'become black' and *gāŋ-gu* 'dry'; compare *gān-a* 'it dried'. The suffix used in the derivation of nominal modifiers is NR1 (see section 5.3), the form used to relativize verbs when the head noun is coreferential with the relative clause subject. Thus all deverbal modifiers may be analysed syntactically as relative clauses, e.g. *ṭuŋ-gu guābā* 'ripe guava'; 'guava that has ripened'; *hẽga-u parsi* 'red sari'; 'sari that is red'.

Although the majority of property concepts in Dolakhae are deverbal, there are a small number of true adjectives as well, that is, property concepts that form a separate lexical class and do not have the inflectional possibilities of either nouns or verbs. These include *lyās-mā/lyās(i)-misā* 'young (male/female)' <33>, *nullu* 'new', *wẽ/wini* 'crazy (male/female)' and at least 15 others (Genetti 2007: 207). When used attributively, these adjectives precede the noun, although *lyās-mā* and *lyāsi-misā* may be used as nominal compounds, hence function referentially, e.g. <33>. When used predicatively, these adjectives are followed by one of the copulas or the verb *jur-* 'become', depending on tense-aspect.

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3.4 Clitics and particles with discourse function

Dolakha Newar has five morphemes – three particles and two clitics – that together form a central subsystem of discourse structuring. The particles are phonologically independent and can be stressed; the clitics are unstressed and phonologically bound to their host. The five morphemes are in rough paradigmatic alternation and do not co-occur.

The topic particle *wā* follows a noun phrase to highlight a referent as being the entity to which the clause especially pertains, e.g. *āu wā mo-oŋ-gi. libi* [now TOP NEG-go1SPAST later] 'Now I didn't go. (I'll go) later'. This morpheme also occurs after temporals and non-finite clauses <15, 19, 61>. The focus particle *tuŋ* marks elements that constitute new and important information that is explicitly profiled against knowledge that is presupposed. For example, in the phrase *nāpā tuŋ ũ-i ale* [together FOC go-1FUT then] 'let's go together then', there is a presupposition that the two referents of the subject will be going; the new focused information is that they will go together as opposed to separately. The third particle in this set is rather ordinary: *jukun* 'only'.

The two clitics have nearly opposite functions and form an interesting and unusual grammatical subsystem.

The clitic =(*u*)*ri* has an individuating function, so specifies one element out of a group that it contrasts with, e.g. *thābi* = *ri* 'the top one' (<*thābi* 'top'); *thi-mā* = *ri* 'one of the group'. This clitic is commonly used with pronouns and kin terms <76>, in which case it may precede the casemarker, e.g. *kehẽ* = *uri* = *n* 'younger sister (ERG)'. Interestingly, there are cases where this clitic occurs twice in a single word, on both sides of the casemarker: *mā* = *uri* = *n* = *uri*. 'mother (ERG)'. Presumably, the first occurrence represents a lexicalization of the kin term and clitic, and the later occurrence has discourse-pragmatic force.

In contrast to =*(u)ri* is =*(u)ŋ*, which delineates a group of which the host is part; it is glossed as 'extensive'. When bound to a noun phrase with a singular referent, it translates as 'also', e.g. *ji*=*ŋ ũ-i* [1s=EXT go-1FUT) 'I also will go'. When bound to a numeral, it translates as 'both' or 'all'; compare *nis-mā* 'two' with *nis-mā* = *ŋ* 'both'. It also occurs with adverbials, where its interpretation is variable. Common examples are *lita* = *ŋ* 'again' (from *lita* 'next') and *ānthi* = *ŋ* 'just like that' <33> (from *ānthi* 'like that; in that manner').

4 VERBS

4.1 Copula and existential

The copula in Newar is *khyaŋ*, while the intransitive existential verb is *dam(u)*. These verbs are morphologically irregular and independent of the four inflectional verb classes. The existential *dam* has a number of finite and non-finite inflectional forms. Especially common are *da-u*, the past stative form, and *ma-da*, the negative. The copula *khyaŋ* may also be pronounced *khyaũ*; the negative is *ma-khe*.

The primary function of *dam* is existential, as in *gār dam* 'there is a wound'. It is also used in locational constructions with a locative noun phrase: *gār lāhā* = *ku dam* 'the wound is on the arm'. Note that when the location is animate, the verb *con-* 'stay' is used <17>. The existential is also used in possessive constructions in which the possessor is realized as a genitive-marked dependent of the possessed noun, thus *jana mica dam* 'I have a daughter', where *jana* is the genitive form of the first person pronoun; literally the meaning is 'my daughter exists'.

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The copula *khyaŋ* is used equationally, thus *misā ma-khe* 'this is not a woman', *twāŋsona sona khyaŋ* [rhododendron flower COP] 'the rhododendron is a flower'. The negated form *ma-khe* is often used as a strong denial, meaning 'it is not so!' And with the question particle, the form *khe rā?* is commonly used to create a tag, i.e. 'isn't it so?'

4.2 Inflectional verb classes

With the exception of the two verbs just described, all Dolakhae verbs belong to one of four inflectional verb classes. The four classes are most simply characterized by the stem-final consonant which occurs in the third person singular past form of the verb. The four classes are thus n-stems (*on*-a 'went'), r-stems (*yer-a* 'came'), l-stems (*lipul-a* 'returned') and t-stems (*gyāt-a* 'feared'). Each stem class has distinctive morphophonemic variation that is regular for all members of the class.

Verbs borrowed from Nepali are incorporated into the inflectional system in two ways. Transitive verbs are put in stem form and followed by the verb *yet-* 'do', e.g. *ṭār yet-* 'to cross' (from Nepali *ṭār-nu* 'cross (river)'). Intransitive verbs are suffixed by *-ai*, glossed as BVS for 'borrowed verb suffix', then followed by the intransitive verb *jur-* 'become'; 'happen' <31, 70>.

4.3 A complete verb paradigm

A paradigm of the affirmative finite verb *nar-* 'eat' is given in Table 22.1. Only one affirmative finite suffix is not illustrated here; it is the third person singular past suffix *–a*, which is found on intransitive verbs, as opposed to *-cu*/*ju*, which is found on transitive verbs.

The Dolakhae finite verb inflects for four tenses: the past anterior, simple past, present, and future. Tense markers follow the verb directly. The past anterior is *-u*, the past has no marker, the present is *-a*, and the future is *-i*/*-e*. The verb also reflects the person (first, second, third) and number (singular, plural) of the subject. There is no separate verbal inflection to distinguish inclusive and exclusive forms of the first person plural; this distinction is maintained only in the pronouns (see above). Second person honorific forms are identical to those of the first person plural, except in future tense.

In addition to the affirmative, the Dolakhae verb has separate inflectional paradigms for the negative, imperative, prohibitive and optative. The negative has separate but related agreement morphology, but only inflects for three tense categories, the past and present not being distinguished. The optative and prohibitive are marked by prefixes, *tha-* and *da-* respectively. The verbs in these moods and the imperative also inflect for number, each category demonstrating slightly different inflectional patterns.

TABLE 22.1 AFFIRMATIVE PARADIGM OF *NAR-* 'EAT'

	Past Anterior	Past	Present	Future
1s	*na-u-ĩ*	*nar-gi*	*nar-a-gi*	*na-i*
1p	*na-u-pe*	*nar-gu*	*nar-a-gu*	*na-i*
2s	*na-u-n*	*nar-mun*	*nar-a-n*	*na-i-na*
2p	*na-u-min*	*nar-min*	*nar-a-min*	*na-i-nan*
2hon	*na-u-pe*	*nar-gu*	*nar-a-gu*	*na-i-ta*
3s	*na-u(-ju)*	*nar-ju*	*nar-a-i*	*na-e-u*
3p	*na-u-tan*	*nar-hin*	*nar-a-hin*	*na-e-u*

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There are four non-finite forms of the Dolakhae verb. Illustrating again with *nar-* 'eat', they are the infinitive (*na-i*), the participle (*na-en*) and the two nominalizers, NR1 (*na-u*) and NR2 (*na-e*). The functions of these forms are discussed in section 5.3.

4.4 Auxiliary verbs

There are a number of verbs which may be analysed as auxiliaries, and which convey aspect, direction or the presence of a benefactive argument in the clause. While a few of these auxiliaries follow a main verb in the infinitive (e.g. *na-i don-ju* 'finish eating', *na-i ten-a-gi* 'about to eat'), the most common auxiliaries follow a verb in participial form. The three which occur most frequently are *con-* 'sit', 'stay', 'reside', which conveys a progressive aspect <18, 75>, *tal-* 'put' which indicates an extended state or perfect aspect, and *bir-* 'give', which indicates the presence of an affected participant (beneficiary or maleficiary); the NP that refers to the participant may or may not be a grammatical argument of the clause; thus, this is not a strict applicative construction.

5 SYNTAX

5.1 Word order

A noun phrase may consist of the following elements: demonstrative <33, 54>, adjective/relative clause <75>, genitive modifier <3, 11, 12, 43, 65, 75>, quantifier <16>, noun.

Demonstratives are generally phrase-initial <33, 54>. Prenominal demonstratives and independent demonstratives are of identical form. Genitive NPs and relative clauses precede the noun <43, 75>. Nouns are generally final in the phrase, although quantifiers may be positioned postnominally. Head nouns may be omitted if reference is clear from context. The clitic postpositions are bound to the last element in the phrase, even if not nominal.

Dolakha Newar is clearly a verb-final language, although it is possible to postpose arguments or adverbials after a finite verb. When this happens, these elements are in separate intonation units <13, 14>. No postverbal positioning of elements is found with non-finite verbs. Nominal arguments are often omitted if clearly understood from context <11, 12, 15, 19, etc.>, or are of very general or non-specific reference. When subject and object NPs are both present, it is more common for the subject to precede the object <69>. The opposite order is also attested, typically when the object noun phrase is the discourse topic and/or the subject noun phrase is the focus. Adverbial modifiers always precede the verb they modify.

5.2 Grammatical relations

There is clear evidence for subject and object as grammatical categories in Dolakhae. The subject may be readily identified as the NP which controls verb agreement. Also, the suffix glossed NR1 is used when the head of a relative clause is coreferential with the subject (A or S) of the relative clause. There are no passive constructions which derive subjects in this language. Objects are arguments which: (a) are not subjects; (b) are subcategorized for by the semantic structure of transitive and ditransitive verbs; (c) may be marked with the dative = *ta*; and (d) take the suffix NR2 when relativized. There is no evidence that indirect objects and direct objects form distinct syntactic classes (Genetti 1997).

Transitivity is a strong organizational principle in Dolakhae syntax. Any verb which takes a notional object is grammatically transitive, regardless of whether or not the object

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referent is important or specified as an NP. Thus *āmun jā nar-ju* 'he ate the rice' and *āmun nar-ju* 'he ate' are both grammatically transitive, as can be seen from the ergative form of the third person singular pronoun *āmun*, and the consistent use of the transitive 3s suffix *-ju*; with intransitive verbs, the suffix is *-a*. There is no way to detransitivize a transitive clause, although there are a number of transitive/intransitive verb pairs, the transitive containing an aspirated initial, the intransitive containing a voiced initial, e.g. *gyāt-/khyāt-* 'be afraid'/'scare'. (The aspirated form is clearly a reflex of the old causative **s-* prefix reconstructed for Proto-Tibeto-Burman, see Benedict 1972: 105.) Intransitive verbs may be made transitive only through the addition of the causative suffix *-ker*.

5.3 Clause combining

One of the most interesting areas of Dolakhae grammar is the manner in which clauses are woven together to form long sentences of intricate structure (Genetti 2011a). Sentence breaks in narrative discourse may be identified by the presence of a non-embedded finite verb, sometimes followed by particles, and typically produced with a rising or high level intonation contour. The final clause usually ends in a verb with finite morphology and is produced with falling intonation. Example (7) is illustrative of sentence complexity; note that quoted speech is shown in bold:

(7) *ḍwā-ku = ri* *iri* ***oho: \|*** ***ji*** ***yā*** ***githi*** ***yer-i***,
senior-NR1 = IND daughter.in.law EXCL 1s EMPH how do-1FUT
lās ***cār-a-gi*** *haŋ-an*, *ithi:* *yeŋ-an*, *mikhā* *ti-en*
shy feel-PR-1s say-PART like.this do-PART eyes close-PART
on-ŋasin; *ḍirtarāsṭra* *janm-ai* *jur-a.*
go-when Dhirtarāsṭa be.born-BVS be-3SPST
'The eldest daughter-in-law, saying "Oh, how shall I do this? I am feeling shy", and going like this, when she closed her eyes and went, Dhirtarastra was born.'

The three underlined italic verbs in the sentence have the ubiquitous participial suffix, which may be considered a 'converb' similar to those described for Altaic languages (e.g. Johanson 1995; for a full analysis of the construction as a converb, see Genetti 2005). In these examples, the suffix links non-final clauses in a chain with a final clause. If the final clause is finite, chained clauses will depend on it for the specification of tense. Functionally, participial clauses either list events in a causal or temporal sequence (as in the first example above), and/or give adverbial modification to a following verb (as in the second example). These functions are often difficult to differentiate, as the line between them is not clear <e.g. 1, 4>. Note that the first of the chaining verbs, *haŋ-an* in (7) earlier, is a quotative. It functions here as a lexical predicate, but this verb form may also occur as a quotative complementizer <57, 58>. The embedded direct quote is a syntactic object (Genetti and Slater 2004), thus entire sentences may be embedded within sentences in this construction. (For prosodic features of embedded speech, see Genetti 2011b.)

In the last line of (7), the verb *on-ŋasin* carries a temporal suffix that creates an adverbial clause. Adverbial suffixes are distinct from the participial suffix because of their semantic specificity; they denote temporal or logical relationships which hold between the adverbial clause and the following clause <15, 19, 20, 38, 55, etc.>. Genetti (2007: 483–4) compares and contrasts the syntax of adverbial and participial clauses.

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Returning to example (6), note that the subject of the chain, *iri* in the first line, is not marked with the ergative, so is presumably casemarked for the verb *on-ŋasin*, the final verb in the series and the only intransitive one. The final and finite clause of the sentence has a new subject, Dhirtarastra.

Dolakhae has several types of complementation. Verbs in complement clauses are suffixed with either the infinitive or one of the nominalizers, e.g. *na-i mal-a* 'must eat' (with the infinitive), *na-e khon-ju* 'saw him/her eat' (with NR2) <55, 70>. Complements of cognition verbs have an abstract noun incorporated into the structure, which may be analysed either as a nominal constituent of the higher clause, or as a complementizer (e.g. *khã* 'talk', 'matter', *saŋkā* 'suspicion'). The complement verb takes the infinitive plus the emphatic = *uri* if the clause is irrealis, or NR2 if the clause is realis. Thus the phrase *na-i = uri khã*, with the infinitive, may be roughly translated as 'the fact that I'll eat', while *na-e khã*, with NR2, means 'the fact that I ate'. The realis/irrealis distinction is not overtly reflected elsewhere in the morphology of the language.

The two suffixes which are used in nominalized and relative clauses are glossed NR1 and NR2. NR1 has the forms *-gu*, *-ku*, or *-u*, while NR2 is pronounced *-a* or *-e*. The allomorphy depends on the inflectional class of the verb. While in some languages of the Tibeto-Burman family relative clause structures might be argued to be syntactic nominalizations which are in an appositive relationship with the head noun, in Dolakhae the two structures are syntactically distinct (see Genetti *et al*. 2008: 127). The two suffixes NR1 and NR2 are in a paradigmatic relationship, and the distribution of these suffixes *vis-à-vis* each other is complicated and varies by speaker (Genetti 2007: 403–7). A few general patterns can be mentioned here. When these two suffixes are used to form relative clauses, NR1 is used when the head noun is coreferential with the subject of the relative clause, while NR2 is used when the head noun is coreferential with the object. When the head noun is coreferential with an oblique NP, either suffix can be used, and speakers seem to base their judgments on the person of the subject or the tense of the clause. When the two suffixes are used to nominalize complements of perception verbs, NR1 is preferred when the verb is intransitive, and NR2 when the verb is transitive. And in nominalized questions or emphatic constructions, NR1 is the preferred form when the subject is third person, and NR2 when the subject is first or second.

5.4 Other constructions

The comparative in Dolakhae is a bit unusual. The object of comparison appears in the absolutive (unmarked case), followed by *so-en*, the participial form of the verb *sor-* 'look'. This is followed by the attributive clause, e.g. *ji so-en chi bã̃la-ku khyaŋ* 'You are more beautiful than me'. The construction is not a simple case of parataxis. The verb *sor-* normally takes an ergative subject and dative-marked object. The object of comparison, by contrast, is never casemarked. Thus the construction has taken on idiosyncratic properties in the process of grammaticalization.

The reflexive is formed with the reflexive pronoun *thau*. This pronoun necessarily refers back to the subject of the clause. It is most commonly used with a possessive sense, e.g. *āpen thau chẽ oŋ-an . . .* 'they went to their own house'. The reflexive pronoun may be repeated to convey a distributive meaning, e.g. *chipe thau thau chẽ o-n* 'you all go each to your own houses'. The reflexive is generally not used to indicate objects being coreferential with subjects, paratactic expressions being preferred for such cases. The reflexive pronoun can also be used pronominally, if it is coreferential with the subject of the preceding clause.

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6 NARRATIVE TEXT

The following text is a portion of a story told by Mrs Sanu Laxmi Joshi in Dolakha, in January 1989. A small portion has been ellipted, as it contains a summary of the preceding text. The story has been divided into prosodic units, and each unit is set on a separate line and marked for its intonation type by line-final punctuation. The six intonation types are marked by the following conventions:

(8)
.	prototypical final, generally falling pitch
|	narrative final intonation, high-level pitch throughout unit
?	interrogative final, high rise in pitch at end of unit
!	exclamatory final, steep rise-fall of pitch on final syllable
;	anticipatory continuing, strong rise on nucleus of final syllable
,	non-anticipatory continuing, some rise in pitch on final syllable

In addition to breaking the text into prosodic units, with one on each line, the text has also been broken into sentences, based on morphosyntactic and prosodic cues. Embedded quotation is in bold to aid readers in understanding the different levels of structure.

The story concerns Viśnu, who is visiting Śiva and Parvati. In an earlier portion of the story, Śiva has expressed interest in seeing Viśnu in the disguise of a beautiful young maiden, which Viśnu had earlier used to deceive demons. Viśnu has asked Śiva if he would be able to resist falling in love with the young maiden who is actually Viśnu in disguise. Śiva has promised three times that he would.

6.1 Sentence 1

1 *nis-nu* *so-nu* *li*,
two-day three-day after

2 *so-nu* *li*;
three-day after

3 *sora* *barsa = e* *umer*,
sixteen year = GEN age

4 *yārling* *phi-en*;
earring put.on-PART

5 *sāri* *dalkyāŋ-an*;
sari wear-PART

6 *gə̃jal = na* *uŋ-an*;
eyeliner = INST draw-PART

7 *sə̃* *ṭhu-en*;
hair braid-PART

8 *bakundo* *u-en*;
ball dance-PART

9 *hararararaŋ*,
EXP

10 *bisnu* *bāgabān* *on-a.*
Viśnu god go-3SPAST

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'Two or three days later, three days later, as a sixteen-year-old, putting on earrings, wrapping a sari, applying eyeliner, and dancing with a ball, *harararararaŋ*, God Viśnu went.'

6.2 Sentence 2

11 *mohini = e* *abatār* *kā-en*;
maiden = GEN form take-PART

12 *sibaji = e* *bagainca* *on-a*.
Śiva = GEN garden go-3SPAST

13 *kailās* *tarpha-ku*.
Kailaś direction = LOC

14 *baikuntha = lān*.
Baikhuntha = ABL

'Taking the form of a young maiden, he went to Śiva's garden. In Kailaś. From Baikuntha.'

6.3 Sentence 3

15 *āle* *ãku* *on-ŋasin* *wā*;
then there go-when TOP

16 *nis-mā* *siba pārbati*,
two-CL Śiva Pārbati

17 *atāli = ku* *coŋ-an*;
balcony = LOC stay-PART

18 *musukka* *ŋil-en* *coŋ-gu.*
smiling smile-PART stay-3SPH

'Then when he went there, the two of them, Śiva and Parbati, sitting on the balcony, were smiling prettily.'

6.4 Sentence 4

19 *āle* *caṭṭa* *mikhā* *tar-ŋasin* *wā*;
then EXP eye put-when TOP

20 *gulpa = ŋ* *lāhā = ku* *bokunda* *metha-e-thẽ*,
when = EMPH hand = loc ball play-NR2-as.if,

21 *gulpa = ŋ* *bokunda* *metha-e-thẽ*,
when = EMPH ball play-NR2-as.if

22 *sãrpuli* *halyāŋ-an*;
ribbons swing-PART

23 *yārliŋ* *dalkyāŋ-an*;
earring wear-PART

24 *mikhā* *tarkyāŋ-an*;
eye flirt-PART

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25 *miu* *pita* *kā-en*;
?? out take-PART

26 *ebam* *prakār = na* *pyākhan* *u-en*;
every type = INST dance dance-PART

27 *camcamcamcam = na* *yer-ŋasin*;
EXP = INST come-when

28 *caṭṭa* *sibaji = n* *khoŋ-a* *ju-en* *con-a.*
EXP Śiva = ERG see-NR2 be-PART stay-3SPAST

'Then when he put his eyes on her, at one time as if she were playing with a ball in her hand, at another time again as if playing with a ball, her ribbons swinging, her earrings dangling, her eyes flirting, taking out [? unknown], dancing every type of dance, when she came with a *camcamcamcam*, Śiva saw her.'

6.5 Sentence 5

29 *sibaji = n* *khõ-i-sāt*;
Śiva = ERG see-INF-as.soon.as

30 *sibaji puklukka* *aṭāli = lān*,
Śiva EXP balcony = ABL

31 *kotha* *bõ = ku* *jar-ai ju* *ju-en* *con-a.*
room ground = LOC fall-BVS be.NR1 be-PART stay-3SPAST

'As soon as he saw her, Śiva fell – *puklukka* – from the balcony onto the floor of the room.'

6.6 Sentence 6

32 *bõ = ku* *ye-i* *doŋ-an* *li*;
ground = LOC come-INF finish-PART after

33 *āle* *āmu* *bisnu* *bāgabān = ta* *lyāsmisā = ta = ŋ*;
then that Viśnu god = DAT young.woman = dat = EXT

34 *samj-ai* *ju-en*,
remember-BVS be-PART

35 *tin* *lok*;
three realms

36 *caudha* *bhuban*;
fourteen worlds

37 *ḍulyeŋ-an*;
lead-PART

38 *jõ-i-thẽ* *jõ-i-thẽ* *ju-i-ho*,
catch-INF-as.if catch-INF-as.if be-INF-when

39 *ŋil-en*;
smile-PART

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40 *phisikka* *ŋil-en* *thi-khana*,
EXP smile-PART one-side

41 *phisikka* *ŋil-en* *thi-khana*,
EXP smile-PART one-side

42 *phisikka* *ŋil-en* *on-ŋa* *on-ŋa* *on-ŋa*;
EXP smile-PART go-when go-when go-when

43 *āme* *jati* *sibaji = e* *jati*,
3SGEN possessions Śiva = GEN possessions

44 *swāl* *hā-u*,
EXP fall-NR1

45 *bijan*,
seed

46 *lũ*,
gold

47 *oho*,
silver

48 *liuri*,
bronze

49 *pitāl*,
copper

50 *ānāgu* *ānāgu*,
like.that like.that

51 *= pen* *ju-en* *dhātu = pen* *khas-ai* *ju-en* *õŋ-gu* *ju-en* *con-a*|
= PL be-PART metal = PL fall-BVS be-PART go-NR1 be-PART stay-3SPAST

'Then after he fell to the ground, he again remembered Viśnu, the maiden, and she led him through the three realms (heaven, earth, hell) and the fourteen worlds, and when he made as if to catch her, she would smile, smiling on one side, smiling on the other side, going on and on and on smiling, his possessions all fell from him, Śiva's possessions, his seed, gold, silver, bronze, copper, all things like that, metals, they all fell away from him.'

6.7 Sentence 7

52 *āle* *tin* *lok*,
then three realms

53 *caudha* *bhuban* *ḍuler-i* *doŋ-ani*,
fourteen world lead-INF finish-PART

54 ***guli*** ***u*** ***sibaji = ta*** ***ḍulet-ki*** ***dukha*** ***bi***|
how.much this Śiva = DAT lead-1SPAST trouble give.INF

55 ***'chin*** ***māyā = ku*** ***jit-ai*** ***ju-i*** ***phar-a-gu*** ***rā'*** ***hat-ŋasin,***
2SERG love = LOC win-BVS be-INF able-PR-2h Q say-when

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56 ***'ma-pha-gi'***|
NEG-able-1s

57 ***haŋ-an*** ***ha = ku***.
say-PART say-2hPAST

58 ***'phar-a-gi'*** ***haŋ-an*** ***ha-ku***.
able-PR-1s say-PART say-2hPAST

59 *āu* *ākhiri = ku* *ota* *haŋ-ane*,
now end = LOC this say-PART

60 *phyāṭṭa* *ithi*,
EXP like.this

61 *sibaji = n* *jõ-i-sāt* *wā*,
Śiva = ERG catch-INF-as.soon.as TOP

62 *simā = e* – (false start)
tree = GEN

63 *lyāsimisā* *haŋ-a* *jon-ŋasin*;
young.woman say-NR catch-when

64 *simā = e* *thuthā* *jur-a*.
tree = GEN log become-3SPAST

'Then, having led him through the three realms and fourteen worlds, Viśnu said to himself, "I led this Śiva so much to give him trouble. When I said 'Can you win in love?', he said 'I cannot', he said 'I can'." When he spoke like this in the end, suddenly like this, as soon as Śiva caught him, when he caught the one said to be a young woman, he transformed himself into a log.'

6.8 Sentence 8

65 *simā = e* *thuthā* *ju-i-ho*,
tree = GEN log become-INF-when

66 *lās* *cār-a*.
embarrassment feel-3SPAST

'After (Viśnu, disguised as a young maiden) became the log of a tree, (Śiva) became embarrassed.'

6.9 Sentence 9

67 *sibaji* *lās* *cār-a*;
Śiva t embarrassment feel-3SPAST
'Śiva was embarrassed.'

6.10 Sentence 10

68 ***āle*** ***lās*** ***cā-eni***;
then embarrassment feel-PART

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69 ***jin*** ***thaeta*** ***pahilā*** ***tuŋ*** ***ha-ku-i*** ***le***.
1SERG 2hDAT before TOP say-PA-1s PRTCL

70 ***'thamu*** ***māyā = ku*** ***jit-ai*** ***ju-i*** ***phar-a-gu*** ***rā*** |
2HON love = LOC win-BVS happen-INF able-PR-2h Q

71 ***ma-phar-a-gu*** ***rā'*** ***haŋ-an*** ***'phar-a-gi'*** ***ha-kupe***.
NEG-able-PH-2h Q say-PART able-PR-1s say-PI-2h

72 ***gwā*** ***le*** *hat-cu*|
where PRTCL say-3SPAST

'He became embarrassed, then Viśnu said: "I told you before, 'Are you able to win in love or not?' and you said: 'I am able to'. Where is your ability then?"'

6.11 Sentence 11

73 *āle* *ānthi* *har-i-ho*;
then like.that say-INF-when

74 *phisikka* *pārbati = ŋ* *ŋil-en*,
EXP Parbati = TOP smile-PART

75 ***ji*** ***ulistule*** ***bãla-ku*** ***pārbati thae*** ***sāt-ku*** ***coŋ-an*** ***con-a-gi;***
1s like.this beautiful-NR1 Parbati 2hGEN side = LOC stay-PART stay-PR-1s

76 ***thamu = ri*** ***ānthi = ŋ*** ***ŋil-a-gu*** ***rā***|
2h = TOP like.that = EMPH smile-PR-2s Q

'Then when he spoke like that, smiling Parbati also smiled and said "I, Parbati, who am beautiful like this, sit at your side. You smile in just that manner (at some other girl)?"'
(Small portion ellipted here.)

6.12 Sentence 12

77 *sibaji* *summake* *lās* *mā-cā-en* –
Śiba silent embarrassment NEG-feel-PART

78 *lās* *cā-en* *con-a.*
embarrassment feel-PART stay-3SPAST
'Siva silently sat feeling embarrassed.'

ADDITIONAL ABBREVIATIONS

1,2,3	person indices
s,p,h	singular, plural, honorific
BVS	borrowed verb suffix
EXP	expressive vocabulary
EXT	extensive
IND	individuating
NR1~2	nominalizer/relativizer 1 or 2
PA	past anterior
PART	(conjunctive) participle / converb

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